

- If you are saving images for print, do not save in a .jpg format. Remember, jpeg is meant for the human eye, but devices can be affected by the losses.
- If you are going to be editing the file later on as well, they shouldn't be JPEGS, especially not highly compressed ones.

~Setting quality levels and saving jpegs in Photoshop is discussed in Chapter 2.1~

9.2 The GIF format

You would have seen most banners or small images being stored in the .gif format on the web. This is because gif works very well with images that are non-real, like diagrams or straight line images. GIF (Graphic Interchange Format) offers a much better way of rendering straight lines than jpeg does.

GIF is a lossless 8 bit compression technique. This means, so long as the colours can be represented within the $2^8 = 256$ colours that GIF can use, there will be no loss in quality. But if a 24 bit photo image is forced to a GIF format, there will be a quality loss. One has to bear in mind that gif was not designed to be used with real images that have varied colours. For the purposes of scientific drawings, tree diagrams, cartoons, etc, all of which have limited or only black and white colours, GIF offers superb quality for very small file sizes.

An exciting feature of GIF that has added so much life to the web is the ability to animate them. All browsers as of today support the gif animation format. More than one image, rather layers can be embedded in a single file and the browser displays the different layers successively in repetition. This again is achieved with a very less file size.

- Use gif when the image is composed of straight lines and has vast areas of single colour.
- Thumbnails can be created as gifs as their quality is not all